Personal User Manual

A short guide to working with each person: how they like to work, communicate and get feedback. Four people per board.

Set Up the Team · Working With Me · Popularised by Atlassian's Team Playbook

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

TEAM: Basket team

DATE: 5 March

1 Working With Me

ONE PERSON PER BLOCK

Name: Priya | Role: Product owner | Hours / time zone: 09:00–17:30

I do my best work when…
I've talked to customers that week

The best way to reach me is…
a message; I reply within the hour

Give me feedback by…
in person, with an example

What drains me, and what energises me
drains: status meetings;
energises: customer calls

Things people misread about me
"no" means "not yet", not "never"

Ask me about… (I can help with)
customer research, priorities

2 Working With Me

ONE PERSON PER BLOCK

Name: Sam | Role: Developer | Hours / time zone: 08:00–16:00

I do my best work when…
I get a long block of focus time in the morning

The best way to reach me is…
chat after 13:00; mornings are for focus

Give me feedback by…
in writing first, then talk

What drains me, and what energises me
drains: context switching;
energises: hard problems

Things people misread about me
quiet in meetings isn't disagreeing

Ask me about… (I can help with)
payments, APIs, debugging

3 Working With Me

ONE PERSON PER BLOCK

Name: Jo | Role: Developer | Hours / time zone: 10:00–18:30

I do my best work when…
I'm pairing, or have music on and a clear task

The best way to reach me is…
chat any time; I'll say if I'm busy

Give me feedback by…
straight away, kindly

What drains me, and what energises me
drains: unclear tickets;
energises: shipping things

Things people misread about me
I ask lots of questions because I'm interested

Ask me about… (I can help with)
front end, accessibility

4 Working With Me

ONE PERSON PER BLOCK

Name: Mei | Role: Designer | Hours / time zone: 09:30–17:30, Thu off

I do my best work when…
I've seen the real problem, not just the solution

The best way to reach me is…
tag me in the design channel

Give me feedback by…
show me where users struggled

What drains me, and what energises me
drains: pixel debates;
energises: user testing

Things people misread about me
a sketch is a question, not a decision

Ask me about… (I can help with)
journeys, prototypes, research

"What's one thing about working with you that would save your teammates time?"

"What will you do differently now you've read each other's?"

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